



## BRAND GUIDELINES

Asian beauty,  
made easier to  
trust, learn, and love.

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Visual Highlight Guide · v1.0 · April 2026

## WHAT SIMPLEX-ITY STANDS FOR

# The brand idea, promise, and position.

*Asian beauty, made easier to trust, learn, and love.*

## Positioning statement

Simplex-ity is a more trusted, more guided way for Western-market consumers to discover and buy Asian beauty. It combines curated assortment, creator-led teaching, and disciplined commerce design so makeup-led discovery feels less risky, more relevant, and more worth buying from.

## Brand promise

Simplex-ity brings together trusted products, expert-led guidance, and elevated discovery so consumers can explore Asian beauty with confidence.

## Brand tensions to hold

### Premium but not intimidating

Elevated without creating distance. Every surface should feel aspirational and accessible.

### Editorial but still shoppable

Beautiful to browse, purposeful to buy. Discovery and conversion are not competing goals.

### Modern but not cold

Digital-native without becoming clinical. Technology supports the experience; the brand remains human.

### Creator-led but never chaotic

Curated by real people, never overrun by them. Creator energy amplifies the brand; it never overwhelms it.

Full positioning rationale: BX-01 Sections 2 and 4.

## WHO WE ARE BUILDING FOR

## The consumer and her five jobs to be done.

## Primary consumer

An Asian consumer raised in a Western market who wants beauty products that feel more relevant to her skin tone, features, routines, and cultural beauty references than mainstream local retail provides. She discovers products through creators and content, but needs to trust both the product and the retailer before she buys. She converts when the retailer reduces her guesswork.

## Five jobs to be done

- 1 Help me find products that feel **relevant to me**, not just popular in the abstract.
- 2 Help me understand how a product looks, feels, and **wears on skin that is more like mine**.
- 3 Help me move from **creator inspiration to purchase** without wondering whether the product or seller is legitimate.
- 4 Help me shop Asian beauty **without the usual friction** of crowded catalogues, vague copy, or cross-border uncertainty.
- 5 Help me **build a more complete look or routine** rather than forcing me to guess which products go together.

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Full audience tiers and behaviour implications: BX-01 Section 3.

## HOW THE BRAND FEELS

## Personality spectrum.

When copy or creative feels like it is sliding toward the right column, pull it back.

## Guide

Guru

Simplex-ity helps people find the right thing. It does not position itself as an authority to revere or follow blindly.

## Curator

Entertainer

Curation implies intent and discipline. Entertainment implies breadth and novelty. The brand selects with purpose, not for spectacle.

## Thoughtful

Loud

The brand earns attention through quality and relevance. It does not compete through volume, urgency, or noise.

## Refined

Trendy

Trends come and go. The brand is building toward a long-term trust position. Refinement lasts; trend-chasing erodes credibility.

## Confident

Salesy

Confidence presents and guides. Sales pressure creates anxiety and erodes trust. The brand never pushes; it invites.

*The brand should feel like a knowledgeable friend who has done the curation for you and genuinely wants you to find the right thing.*

Full personality and voice principles: BX-01 Section 5.

## HOW THE BRAND SPEAKS

## Six voice principles.

**Clear, not cluttered**

Simplify without dumbing things down. One idea per sentence. One message per surface moment. Stacked claims and bloated phrasing are a trust drain, not a persuasion tactic.

**Confident, not pushy**

Sound assured and selective, not aggressive or urgent. The brand never pressures. It presents and guides. Urgency language is prohibited.

**Educated, not overexplained**

Teach with taste and restraint. Give the right level of context, then stop. If the reader already knows, trust them. If they need context, give it once, clearly.

**Warm, not sugary**

Feel welcoming and human without sounding childish or breathless. Warmth comes from usefulness, not exclamation marks. Enthusiasm is earned, not performed.

**Curated, not crowded**

Imply discernment in every line. Not everything belongs. Copy should feel selective even when describing a broad collection. If it could be from any retailer, rewrite it.

**Modern, not robotic**

Technology can support the experience, but beauty is always the lead story. Let the brand feel human. AI is a support layer, not an identity. Never let it become the headline.

## One hard punctuation rule

**No em dashes.** They introduce a register that conflicts with the brand's clarity principles. Use a colon, a semicolon, a comma, or rewrite the sentence. This applies to human and AI-generated copy equally.

## The gut-check

Before anything ships: does it trust first, guide second, and delight third? Does every claim have something operational behind it? Does it sound like Simplex-ity, or could it be from any other brand?

Full voice and language register: BX-01 Sections 5 and 7.

## THE PALETTE

## Six approved colours.

Any colour outside this set requires explicit approval and should be treated as an exception, not an extension.

**Primary lilac**

#8c82fc

Headlines, logo on white, editorial framing

**Accent violet**

#5e50fb

Emphasis, active states, calls to action

**Soft lilac**

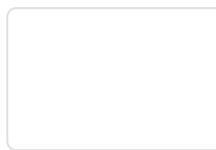
#bab4fd

Supporting backgrounds, card fills

**Lavender wash**

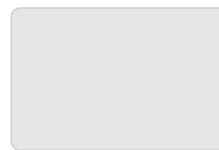
#e8e6fe

Light section backgrounds, subtle framing

**White canvas**

#ffffff

Primary page background — most of every layout

**Neutral grey**

#e6e6e6

Borders, dividers, inactive states

**Body text: #1a1a1f**

Near-black. Pure black (#000000) is not used for body copy — it creates excessive contrast against white.

## Colour usage discipline

**White leads**

White should carry most of every layout. Purple signals the brand; it does not flood it.

**Purple as signature**

Lilac leads headings and brand moments. When purple dominates a page it reads as software, not beauty.

**Violet is selective**

Accent violet is for emphasis and active states. Do not use it as a fill for large surface areas.

Full colour system and usage discipline: BX-01 Section 11.1.

## THE TYPE SYSTEM

## Two typefaces. One system.

## PRIMARY / IDENTITY — EXO

Exo

Asian beauty, made easier to trust.

Light 300   Regular 400   **SemiBold 600**   **Bold 700**

Headlines, section titles, slogan lines, brand statement moments. Use at generous scale with open tracking. Sentence or title case only — all-caps at large scale reads aggressive, not elevated.

## SECONDARY / BODY — MONTSERRAT

Montserrat

Chosen for finish, wear, and real-life use. See why it made the edit, how it looks on different skin, and how creators actually use it.

Regular 400   Medium 500   **SemiBold 600**   **Bold 700**

All running copy, supporting headers, navigation, and functional UI text. Regular and medium for body. Semi-bold or bold for subheadings. Do not introduce thin weights for large body text blocks.

## What to avoid

- × Introducing additional typefaces
- × Decorative effects on type
- × Compressed layouts that fight the spacious editorial feel
- × Mixing Exo and Montserrat at the same weight and size

## Fallback (production outputs)

If Exo is not available: Exo 2 (Google Fonts) first, then Calibri. Montserrat falls back to Calibri. Note fallback use in document footers.

Full type system and usage rules: BX-01 Section 11.2.

## LOGO VARIANTS AND USAGE

## Three approved variants.

Each variant has a defined use context. Using the wrong variant in the wrong context undermines visual integrity.

**Full colour**

Default logo. Use only on white or very light backgrounds.

**SIMPLEX-ITY****White version**

Use on photography, coloured backgrounds, or dark surfaces.

**SIMPLEX-ITY****Black version**

Use where colour is not available (single-colour print, embossed, co-branding).

**Working placeholder:** White and black variants shown above use CSS text as placeholders. Production-quality white and black logo files need to be recreated from the authoritative vector file held by Kieran.

### Usage rules

- ✓ Full-colour only on white backgrounds
- ✓ Maintain clear space at all times
- ✓ Switch to white or black on non-white backgrounds

### Violations — never do

- × Rotate or distort in any dimension
- × Recolour outside the three approved variants
- × Apply shadows, outlines, or effects
- × Place on backgrounds that reduce legibility

Full logo system and violations: BX-01 Section 11.3. Logo tagline decision: see page 9.

## DECIDE BEFORE LAUNCH

## The logo text does not scale.

The current logo includes the line "One Stop Asian Beauty — Simplify to Amplify." Two problems require Kieran's decision before launch copy locks.

**Conflict with brand positioning**

"One Stop" directly contradicts the curation positioning and appears on the prohibited phrases list. "Simplify to Amplify" and the brand idea "Asian beauty, made easier to trust, learn, and love" express different intentions and cannot co-exist as equal brand statements.

**Does not scale on mobile**

At the sizes a logo is used on a mobile navigation bar, email header, or social avatar, the logo text becomes illegible. The wordmark reads clearly; the additional text becomes visual noise. See the scaling demonstration below.

**Scaling demonstration**

How the logo reads across contexts, with additional text vs. wordmark alone.

Desktop header  
~200px

**SIMPLEX-ITY**

ONE STOP ASIAN BEAUTY · SIMPLIFY TO AMPLIFY

**SIMPLEX-ITY**

Barely legible

Mobile header  
~120px

**SIMPLEX-ITY**

ONE STOP ASIAN BEAUTY · SIMPLIFY TO AMPLIFY

**SIMPLEX-ITY**

Illegible

Email header  
~90px

**SIMPLEX-ITY**

ONE STOP ASIAN BEAUTY · SIMPLIFY TO AMPLIFY

**SIMPLEX-ITY**

Invisible

**Decision required from Kieran before launch**

Option A: Keep logo text as-is (does not resolve scaling or copy conflict issues). Option B: Revise logo text to align with the brand idea. Option C: Remove logo text and use the wordmark alone. Until a decision is made, do not use the logo text in any brand copy or campaign material.

## HOW IMAGES WORK

# Imagery is where the brand's warmth lives.

The palette and typography are cool and considered. Photography brings the human, sensory, and aspirational quality the colour system cannot carry alone.

**✓ PRODUCT STILL-LIFE (LEAD FORMAT)**

- ✓ Styled flat-lay with silk and botanical accents
- ✓ Soft, diffused, luminous lighting — no harsh shadows
- ✓ Lavender, white, or pale neutral surfaces
- ✓ 1 to 3 products per frame — implies curation, not catalogue
- ✓ Clean composition with generous negative space

**✓ CREATOR PORTRAITURE (SECONDARY)**

- ✓ Real creators, not models or AI-generated faces
- ✓ Editorial styling — considered, intentional, clean
- ✓ Natural skin — the brand is not built on heavy retouching
- ✓ Soft lavender or white backdrops where possible
- ✓ Makeup and product visible and legible in frame

**✗ ANTI-PATTERNS**

- ✗ AI-generated idealised or symmetrical portraits
- ✗ Floating tech-UI overlays on photography
- ✗ Phone screens with AI interfaces as hero visuals
- ✗ Heavily filtered or skin-perfecting imagery
- ✗ More than 5 products per frame (reads as catalogue)

**COMPOSITION PRINCIPLES**

- ✓ White-led pages — most of the layout should be white
- ✓ Generous whitespace — spacious layouts feel curated
- ✓ One strong visual focus per section or screen
- ✓ Visual flow: brand statement to product to action
- ✓ Grid-aligned layouts — asymmetry only when purposeful

Photography reference: pitch deck page 8 (Beauty of Joseon still-life). Full imagery direction: BX-01 Section 11.4.

## THE NINE SURFACES

## Tone matrix.

Always clear. Always trust-building. Flex on warmth, formality, and length by surface. Two rules that never flex: no em dashes, and trust signals before desirability signals.

| Surface         | Tone direction                                                   | Example                                                                                                        |
|-----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Homepage        | Clear, polished, lightly aspirational. Trust first.              | "Discover Asian beauty with more confidence, from a curated makeup-led assortment shaped for real-life wear."  |
| PDP             | Practical, informed, encouraging.                                | "Chosen for finish, wear, and real-life use. See why it made the edit and how creators actually use it."       |
| Creator brief   | Elevated, collaborative, credible. Teach first.                  | "Your job is to make the product easier to understand, easier to picture on real skin, and easier to trust."   |
| Service reply   | Calm, direct, human, trust-repairing. No deflection.             | "We've looked into this. Your order left our warehouse on [date]. Here's your tracking link."                  |
| Social (IG)     | Editorial, purposeful, confident. Caption adds the useful layer. | "Why this made the edit: buildable coverage that doesn't settle into pores. Shot in natural light, no filter." |
| Social (TikTok) | Hook-first, slightly more casual, still on-brand.                | "Most people skip this step. Here's why it matters for glass skin."                                            |
| Email           | Trusted editor tone. One clear focus. No catalogue push.         | Subject: "Three products that work better together." No false urgency. No all-caps.                            |
| Error states    | Calm, honest, helpful. No false cheer. Direct, clear next step.  | "Nothing matched that search. Try a texture, finish, or brand name instead."                                   |
| Investor-facing | Data-anchored, commercially specific, confident.                 | "Phase 1 validates trust and conversion mechanics through a makeup-led, curated assortment."                   |

Full tone direction and hero examples for all 9 surfaces: BX-01 Section 6. Per-surface AI prompt templates: BX-01 Section 12.2.

## WORDS THAT BUILD TRUST, WORDS THAT ERODE IT

## What we say. What we do not say.

Use this as an active drafting check. Copy sliding into the avoid column is the fastest sign that brand trust is eroding.

## ✓ LEAN INTO

Trusted Curated Guided Selected Authentic

Elevated Thoughtful Creator-led Tailored

Confidence Clear Finish Wear Routine

Discovery Relevant Why it was selected

Real-life use Informed

## ✗ NEVER SAY

One-stop shop Hottest picks Must-have deals

Beauty hacks Trendiest products Disrupt

Revolutionize Cutting-edge innovation

Game-changer Best prices everywhere

All your beauty needs Viral beauty destination

AI-powered personalisation Community-loved

Creator-approved Works for everyone False urgency

Clinical efficacy claims

## The test for borderline words

Ask whether a specific, verifiable claim backs the word. If yes, it is usable. If the word is doing emotional work that a fact should be doing, replace it with the fact.

## One structural rule

**No em dashes** in any copy, human or AI-generated. Use a colon, semicolon, or comma instead. If it only works with a dash, rewrite it.

## WHAT THE BRAND DOES NOT LOOK LIKE

## Seven conditions that cause the brand to drift.

These are not stylistic preferences. They are the conditions that pull the brand away from trust and toward noise or hard-tech, both of which damage the core proposition.

**Discount marketplace clutter**

Crowded grids, excessive sale badges, price-forward layouts, and visual noise actively weaken trust. Even a strong product loses credibility in a cluttered frame.

**Hard-tech interface aesthetics**

Neon UI overload, heavy futuristic effects, floating interface elements on photography, and overly clinical AI-adjacent visuals pull the brand away from beauty toward software.

**AI-rendered idealised portraits**

Symmetrical, smoothed, AI-generated faces undercut the authenticity the brand is built on. They also read increasingly as AI to consumers becoming sensitive to the difference.

**Mobile phone as hero with AI badge**

Showing a phone screen with an AI interface as the hero visual signals "beauty-tech app," not "trusted beauty retail." This is the visual equivalent of leading with technology before trust.

**Childish or trend-desperate styling**

Meme graphics, chaotic stickers, slang-heavy overlays, and overly playful typography undermine the editorial position. On-trend can read off-brand very quickly.

**Generic over-retouched beauty imagery**

Heavily filtered or skin-perfecting imagery feels dishonest in a brand built on authenticity and real-life wear. Aspirational and polished is right; unrecognisably altered is not.

**Visual-verbal consistency check**

Copy claims curation but the layout looks crowded (the layout wins). Copy claims authenticity but images feature AI-generated faces (the images win). Run visual-verbal consistency checks (rubric items 23-25) on any asset where copy and image appear together.

## BEFORE ANYTHING SHIPS

## Brand self-check.

Five gut-check questions every piece of copy should answer before it is published or returned from an AI tool.

**1 Trust first**

Does this copy make the brand feel more credible, not just more interesting?

**2 Curation over breadth**

Does every product, creator, and claim in this copy earn its place?

**3 Guidance, not hype**

Does this teach something or reduce a decision? Or does it just amplify noise?

**4 Creator as educator**

If a creator appears, do they feel like an informed guide, not a promotional channel?

**5 Technology as support**

If technology is mentioned, is it in the background, enhancing the experience without becoming the story?

**25-item Brand Self-Check Rubric**

For a full systematic evaluation of any copy or AI output before publication, use the 25-item rubric in BX-01 Section 12.5. Items score 0 (fail), 1 (partial), or 2 (pass). Any item scoring 0 requires revision before use. Six clusters: message hierarchy, trust signals, language register, tone fit, proof discipline, and visual-verbal consistency.

For AI-generated copy: load the master system prompt from BX-01 Section 12.1 at the start of every session. The 54-entry YAML do-not-say register is in Section 12.4.



Asian beauty, made easier  
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#### DOCUMENT DIRECTORY

##### **This document**

Visual Highlight Guide v1.0  
15-page shareable summary

Positioning, Audience, Personality, Voice,  
Palette, Typography, Logo, Imagery,  
Language, Tone

##### **Full playbook**

BX-01 AI-First Brand Playbook v1.0  
Complete system with AI tools

Sections 1-16: Strategy, Visual System, AI  
Prompts, Rubric, Examples, Governance,  
Glossary